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Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

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Submitter Information

Name: Anonymous Anonymous

General Comment

Reading through the executive order regarding A.I., one cannot help but notice a distinct lack of understanding in what A.I. is or what viable use cases there are. The niche use cases for purpose built A.I. in medical analysis and other scientific fields can be valuable in the hands of experts and those who understand the fundamental limitations of A.I. The A.I. referred to in common parlance and the executive order is a different matter, and the methods to create or "improve" it have proven to be inefficient and unethical. Big technology companies already have outsized influence and power over us and they do not need even more power and influence. The government should not allow them to disregard existing intellectual property laws for the sake of "global AI dominance". People are the true innovators and creators; thus the encouragement for creation and innovation must be directed toward the people, not A.I. or its facilitators.

If A.I. is to be used, there must be barriers and policies in place to prevent mishandling of that tool. Below are guardrails that I think most living the the United States would find reasonable and essential to protect our rights.

COPYRIGHT:

Copyrighted material or creative commons licensed works must not be used for any artificial intelligence purposes unless written consent is given by the original creator(s) of the works. Failure to obtain consent must be considered a violation of the law and the entity operating or training the A.I. must remove the data from the training data set and pay restitution to the original creator(s) as applicable.

OPT-IN AND OPT-OUT RIGHTS:

All individuals, companies, or organizations have a fundamental right to not have their works, likenesses, information, et cetera, used in training artificial intelligence by default. Any service that uses A.I. or may use A.I. in the future, must allow users to opt-in if they want to allow their data to be used in this manner. It is not acceptable for users to be automatically opted-in or retroactively opted-in. Any user must be allowed to opt-out if they so choose and have their data removed from the data training set. Software or services that offer A.I. must allow that set of features or options to be permanently removed at the client level.

WATERMARKING & METADATA:

Generative A.I. outputs must have conspicuous watermarks indicating that the output was A.I. made. Metadata must include and not be limited to: A.I. model(s) used, creation timestamps, and platform or service used. This is a must for transparency and integrity of accurate information.

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